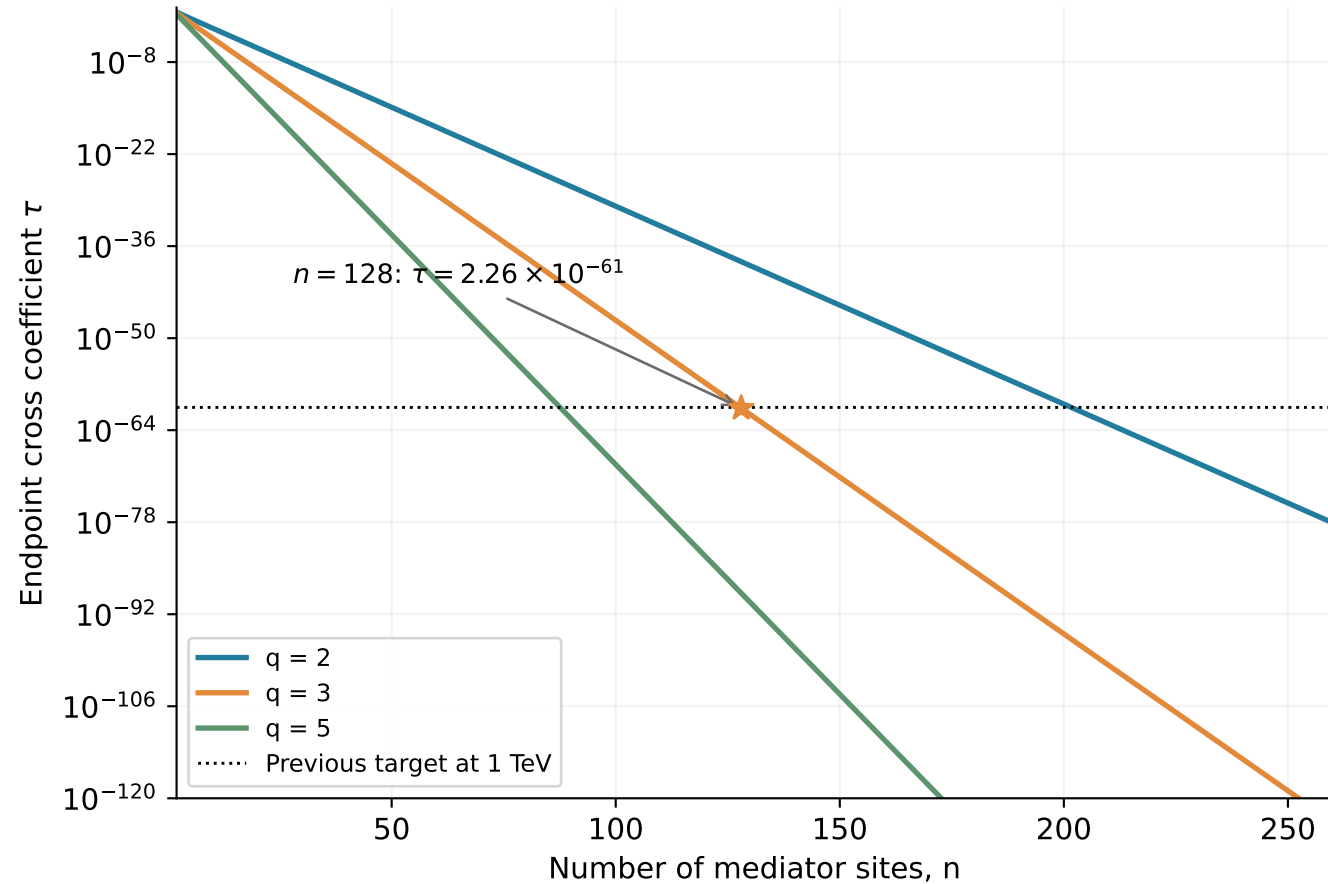
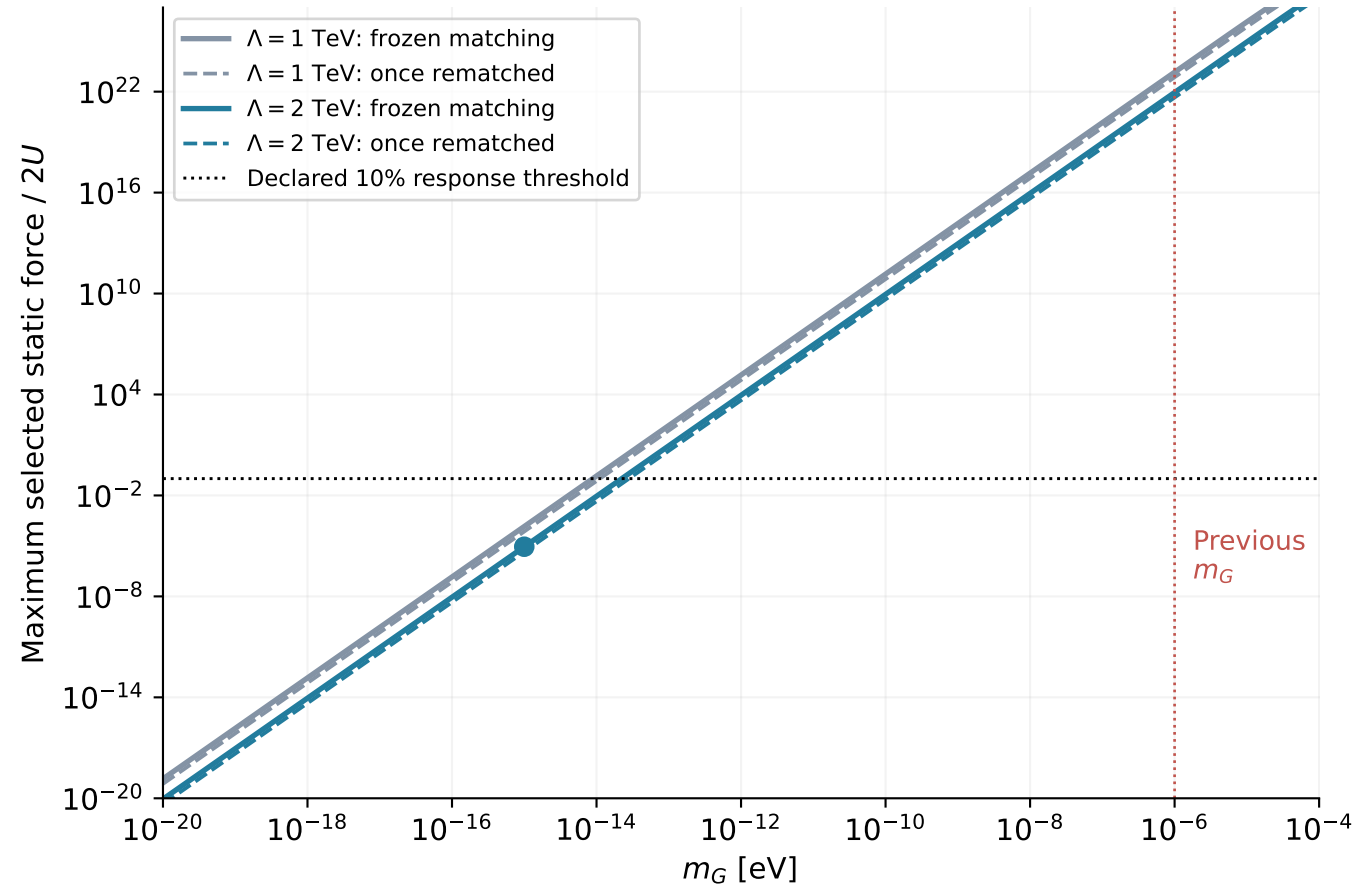


(a) A chain generates a tiny cross coupling



(b) The hidden self response is not suppressed



Local endpoint couplings are order one; the complete matching retains $-|X_c|^4/\Lambda^2$.

Right panel: aligned phase, old clock interval, selected tree response only. The 1 TeV cases also fail the stated charged-mass gap condition.